

City of Orange Township – City Council

Regular Meeting Minutes – February 17, 2026

MINUTES CITY COUNCIL – CITY OF ORANGE TOWNSHIP, NEW JERSEY

THIS IS THE REGULAR MEETING OF THE CITY COUNCIL OF THE CITY OF ORANGE TOWNSHIP HELD AT CITY HALL, 29 NORTH DAY STREET, ORANGE, NEW JERSEY ON TUESDAY, FEBRUARY 17, 2026 FOLLOWING THE CONFERENCE MEETING.

Councilmember Jamie B. Summers-Johnson led all assembled in the pledge of allegiance to the flag.

ROLL CALL

Present: All seven Councilmembers present.

Also Present: Trisha A. Scipio, Deputy Municipal Clerk; Chris M. Hartwyk, Business Administrator; Derrick Brown, Fire Chief; Brian Mooney, Police Chief; Gracia R. Montilus, Esq. City Attorney; Marlin G. Townes, Esq. Legislative Research Officer.

APPROVAL OF MEETING MINUTES

February 3, 2026 Conference and Regular Meeting Minutes adopted. Councilmember Adrienne K. Wooten (who was absent) abstained. Motion Adopted.

REPORTS

DEPARTMENT MONTHLY REVENUE COLLECTIONS: For January 2026, Clerk's Office \$151.32, Community Service \$15,927.00, Health Department \$16,678.00, Planning Board \$56,982.00, Parking Meters \$3,398.27, Public Works \$8,961.00, Tax Assessor \$10 (October 2025) and \$30 (November 2025).

OPRA REPORTS: For January 2026, 93 requests received, 5 completed, 88 outstanding.

CITIZEN COMMENTS

Alysa Rodriguez of 487 Mountainview Avenue addressed OPRA requests, Fire and Police study, street paving, sidewalk improvements, affordable housing, Resolutions 119-2026 and 126-2026, City's new insurance coverage, Scotland Road, rodent concerns, and walk-on resolutions.

Dr. Gloria Boseman of 345 Olcott Street continued to raise concerns about new development, low-income capacity, affordable housing, the hiring process, renters insurance, Trust Fund, and community engagement.

Jason Grove of Seven Oaks Road expressed appreciation to Department Heads for participating in the recent Community Meeting and shared frustrations about ongoing traffic issues.

Kweli Campbell of 55 Randolph Place shared thoughts about Metcalf Park renovations, Open Space and Recreation Committee, water bill increases, noise levels, and Community Benefits Agreements.

Antoinett Hall of 214 Duane Street expressed concerns regarding heating issues at 400 Oakwood Avenue, 300 Oakwood Avenue, and 210 Central Place. Investigation is ongoing.

COUNCIL COMMENTS

Councilmember Quantavia L. Hilbert thanked Police, Fire, and DPW for snow removal. She expressed concerns regarding the cleanliness of the City and enforcement of codes related to trash receptacles.

Councilmember Tency A. Eason thanked residents for patience during snow removal operations and urged caution regarding black ice.

Councilmember Kerry J. Coley thanked residents for patience during snow removal and addressed a construction site not maintaining proper cleanliness.

Council Vice President Weldon M. Montague, III inquired about the Recreation Center and Parking Utility. He requested an update on parking meters from Main Street to Park Avenue, announced free tax preparation events for households earning

under \$69,000, and announced he and Councilmember Ross will sponsor children to attend summer camp.

Councilmember Clifford R. Ross inquired about barriers on Scotland Road, security coverage at City Hall, and possible use of the Upper Field House as a warming station. He thanked attendees at the recent Community Meeting.

Councilmember Jamie B. Summers-Johnson attended the Valentine's Day fundraiser at Orange High School, served as guest speaker for a virtual event at Zion Hill Church, and spoke about Mother Fleury who tragically lost her husband and two daughters in a fire.

Council President Adrienne K. Wooten wished everyone a Happy Black History Month, spoke about the recent Community Meeting and highlighted the upcoming caregiver event.

ORDINANCES

1-2026: Pulled by Administration.

CONSENT AGENDA – RESOLUTIONS 106-2026 THROUGH 127-2026

106-2026: Transfer of appropriation reserves.

107-2026: Emergency temporary appropriations #2 to the CY 2026 budget.

108-2026 through 127-2026: Various resolutions including contracts for PFK O'Connor Davies (auditors), legal counsel, NJACCHO grant, Greater Essex Counseling Services (opioid treatment), Parts Authority (automotive parts), Newark Asphalt Corp, Challenger Fence Inc., and the bill list for February 17, 2026 (Grand Total: \$4,888,346.35). Motion Adopted.

RESOLUTIONS REMOVED FROM CONSENT

126-2026: Poetry services – Pulled by Administration.

WALK-ON RESOLUTIONS

128-2026WO: Bond Combination Resolution providing for General Improvement Bonds (\$4,995,000) and Bond Anticipation Notes. Adopted.

129-2026WO: Appointment of Lerch, Vinci & Bliss, LLP for Finance/Administration/Water and Sewer consultant services, not to exceed \$150,000.00. Adopted.

130-2026WO: Enabling Resolution for Green Acres Program Supplemental Funding for Metcalf Park. Adopted.

131-2026WO: Services of Cleary Giacobbe Alfieri Jacobs, LLC as Special Counsel for Election Matters, not to exceed \$20,000.00. Adopted.

133-2026WO: Submission of Application to NJDEP and NJ Environmental Infrastructure Trust for Citywide Lead Pipe Replacement Program. Adopted.

Executive Session entered at 9:13pm, regular session resumed at 9:28pm.

POSTPONED ORDINANCES

53-2025: Postponed to April 7, 2026.

ADJOURNMENT

Meeting adjourned at 9:30pm. Next meeting: Tuesday, March 3, 2026.

Approved: March 3, 2026

Trisha A. Scipio, Deputy Municipal Clerk

Adrienne K. Wooten, Council President